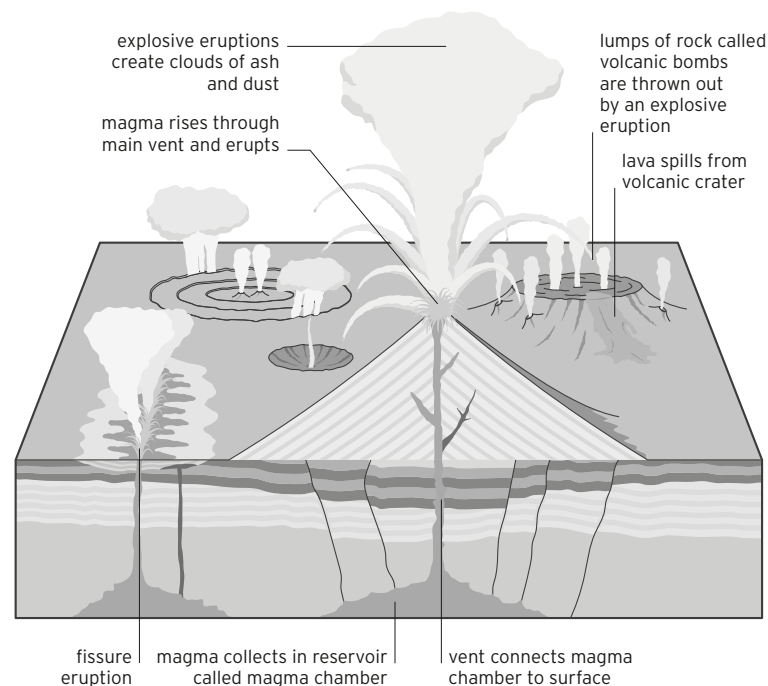
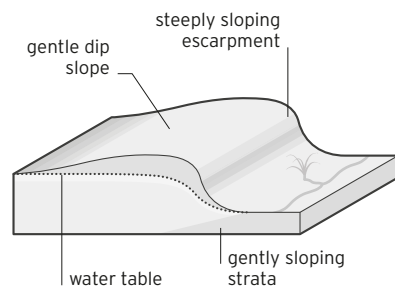


ERUPTION

The discharge of gas, lava, ash, or volcanic bombs from a volcano is called an eruption. Different types of volcanic eruption include Hawaiian, Plinian, Strombolian, Surtseyan, and Vulcanian. Depending on the type of eruption, lava, dust, ash, or pyroclastic bombs are ejected from a main vent, while secondary vents, or fumaroles, may produce smoke and steam.



ERUPTION See panel, above.



ESCARPMENT ▲ The steep slope at the edge of a plateau, or at the

edge of an area of exposed, gently sloping strata, separating two relatively level areas of different elevation. Also called a scarp.

ESKER A long, typically winding, ridge of gravel or sand left behind by a glacier. Eskers mark the position of former meltwater channels beneath or within the ice. See also *glacier*, *meltwater channel*.

ESTUARY The wide lower course of a river from where it flows into the ocean. Estuaries experience tidal flows and are often zones of deposition.

EUSTASY A global change in sea level produced by a change in the amount of water in the oceans. This change usually results from a change in the volume of Earth's ice sheets.

EUTROPHICATION The process by which lakes and other water bodies are enriched with nutrients from fertilizers.

EVAPORITE A sediment formed when a salty lake or oceanic lagoon evaporates. Examples of evaporites include calcite, gypsum, and halite.

EVERGREEN Describing trees bearing leaves all year round. See also *deciduous*.

EXFOLIATION A weathering process that involves layers of rock peeling off in sheets instead of grain by grain.

EXFOLIATION DOME A large, dome-shaped mass of rock, such as granite, whose form has been produced by exfoliation. See also *exfoliation*.

EXTRUSIVE IGNEOUS ROCK Rock that forms when magma reaches Earth's surface and quickly cools and solidifies. For example, basalt and rhyolite. See also *intrusive igneous rock*.

F

FAST ICE Frozen water that is secured to the coast. If it rises more than 6 ft (2 m) above sea level, it is called an ice-shelf. See also *ice-shelf*.

FAULT See panel, below.

FEN A wetland that receives water mainly from groundwater seepage and where the soils are composed almost entirely of dead plant matter, such as peat.

FETCH The distance across open water that a wave or the wind has traveled.

FISSURE ERUPTION The emission of lava through a linear vent, which may be many miles long. See also *eruption* (panel).

FJORD A former glacial valley on a coast that has been submerged by a rise in sea level and has become an inlet of the sea.

FLASH POINT The temperature at which superheated water changes to steam.

FLASH-FLOOD A sudden, often destructive flood occurring after heavy rainfall.

FAULT

A fracture where the rocks on either side have moved relative to one another and often extend through the crust for many miles is called a fault. In normal and reverse faults, one section of the crust slips down, or rises up, in relation

to the other. In strike-slip faults, one section slides past another, with little or no vertical movement. Great forces are involved in the formation of thrust faults, where older rocks are thrust over younger strata.

